

Your shopping checklist

CD-Writer

- Make sure that the drive has a high spin speed and fast access times. If you need to read non-sequential data such as a game, then access time should be your point of concern.
- Does it support over-burning?
- Does it support Multi-Session and Incremental Packet Writing?
- Does it support RAW writing?
- Does it include a CD-burning software?

DVD-ROM drive

- A DVD-ROM drive should be able to read dual-sided DVD media.
- Opt for a 16X—the fastest speed available.
- Also, ask for the warranty period and the parts covered in the warranty.
- Make sure you buy a DVD-ROM drive that has at least 512 KB as buffer memory.
- Opt for a slot DVD-ROM, rather than the



one with the tray, since they last longer.

- Ensure that a good DVD playback software such as WinDVD is provided along with the drive.

External vs internal writers

Choosing between an external and an internal drive depends primarily on your requirements.

- Internal drives are usually cheaper. Opt for

one if you are a home user.

- Till date, due to their interface, external writers were slower as compared to their internal counterparts. However, with the arrival of FireWire and USB 2.0, this is no longer a problem.
- The greatest advantage of an external USB CD-Writer is that it can be hot-plugged to the PC (i.e., there's no need to shut down and restart).
- External writers come with the added baggage of SCSI/FireWire/USB 2.0 cards that add to the budget.
- Internal CD-Writers tend to hog a great deal more of the system's resources.
- Buffer underruns used to be a big problem with internal drives, but that's been solved using buffer underrun protection technology.

Taking care

- Never use poor quality detergents and sprays for cleaning. Clean the drives using a soft, dry fabric.
- Keep the tray clean. Use a duster for thorough cleaning.
- Use an uninterrupted power supply (UPS) for your PC. This protects your system from any drastic power surges.
- Do not push the tray to close it; use the eject button instead.
- Never force the tray out, if it doesn't eject automatically. Use the pin provided with the drive to remove it manually.
- Use a good quality lens cleaner to keep the lens clean, as this is one of the most important parts of the drive.

Liteon optical drives
can read/write
99 minute cd's
compared to limitation
of 81 to 89 mins of
others brands

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8x Dual DVD±RW

Featuring **fastest 8x writing speed** for both formats 8x DVD+R and 8x DVD-R. Write a 4.5GB movie file on DVD in approximately 9 minutes with included software and play on most home DVD players. Can also write CDs at 40x speed.

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